Icelandic conference · 25 March 2026

# The digital journey of the 98 Danish municipalities

KOMB:T

# Agenda

01 Digital Denmark

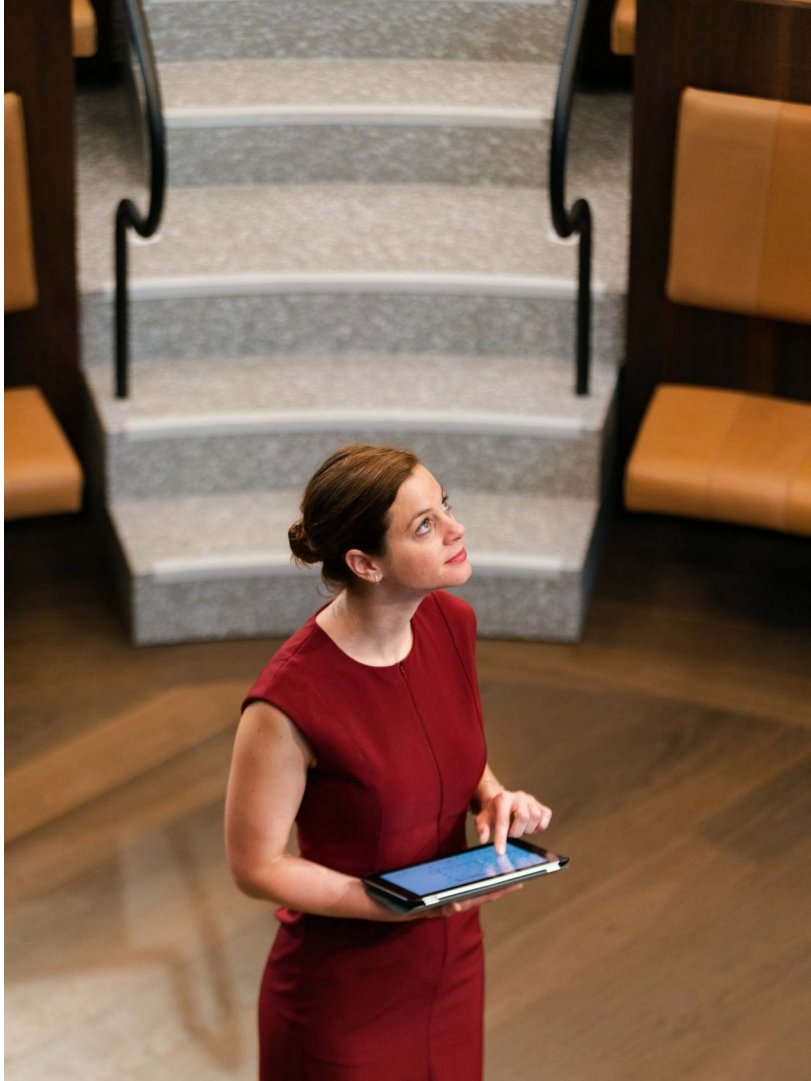
02 KOMBIT

03 Portfolio and infrastructure

04 Cyber and AI

05 Governance

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01

# Digital Denmark

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# Three levels of government

## The state

- Defence
- Police and courts
- Universities and upper secondary schools
- Highways

**Financed by state taxes**

## 5 regions

- Hospitals and psychiatry
- Regional public transport
- Regional development

**Financed by state grants**

## 98 municipalities

- Childcare and elderly care
- Public schools
- Employment
- Social services
- Culture and libraries
- Local public transport
- Passports and driver's licences

**75 % local taxes · 25 % state grants**

**Municipalities by number of inhabitants (total approx. 6 million)**

**7** under 20,000

**18** 20,000–30,000

**37** 30,000–50,000

**36** over 50,000

# Denmark's digital journey – the state track

Joint digitisation strategies across state, regions and municipalities have built the national digital foundation since 2001.

## 2001

**Digital cooperation**

Digital signature; e-mail to the public sector; authorities communicate digitally

## 2004

**Effective payments**

NemKonto and e-invoicing; virk.dk and sundhed.dk; secure e-mail between authorities

## 2007

**Common infrastructure**

NemID, NemLog-in, eIncome, Digital Post, borger.dk; common IT architecture

## 2011

**Digital communication**

Digital Post for companies; self-service for citizens and companies; digital welfare

## 2016

**Better use of data**

Sharing public data; coherent user journeys; new generations of Digital Post and ID

## 2021–

**Public-private strategy**

Emerging technologies, data economy, health and climate, cyber and information security

# Almost everything is digital

Denmark has a shared national digital foundation that citizens, companies and authorities use every day.

- **Digital Post** – mandatory digital mail
- **NemKonto** – mandatory bank account for payments
- **MitID** – national two-factor ID and sign-on
- **eIncome** – digital income and tax
- **Digital IDs** – driver's licence and health card
- **Aula** – school–parent communication platform
- **borger.dk · virk.dk · sundhed.dk** – portals and apps
- **Standards and cyber** – data standards and national cyber



02

# KOMBIT

KOMBIT

# From monopoly to a multi-vendor market

When the municipal IT company was sold in 2008, it created a private monopoly. The municipalities founded KOMBIT to break it up.

**1972**

Municipal data centres merge into KMD, a joint municipal IT company

**2008**

KMD is sold with all critical systems – a private monopoly is created

**2009**

KOMBIT is founded to break up the monopoly and modernise municipal IT

**2013**

Standards developed as the foundation for a multi-vendor market

**2015**

Tendering completed – most of the monopoly portfolio under new contracts

**2018**

All municipalities move to the shared infrastructure; new systems deployed

**2021–**

All 17 critical systems deployed. Vendor management, support and retendering




# KOMBIT at a glance

**Owned by the municipalities**

Founded in 2009 by the 98 municipalities via KL – and fully owned by them

**What we do**

Specify, tender, manage vendors and run large IT systems and infrastructure for all 98

**Non-profit**

Aims to break even, but runs under private-sector company regulations

**Financing**

€160 million equity funds projects; municipalities repay over the contract period (4–10 years)

**People and board**

250 employees. Board of 5 mayors and 3 employee representatives

# One wholesale model for 98 municipalities

**98 municipalities**
Owners and users of the solutions

↔

**KOMBIT**
Buys on behalf of all 98

↔

**IT vendors**
Compete in open tenders

**Payment model**

**€1** **per citizen per year**

Costs are shared by population – an objective, transparent unit for all municipalities.

Example: a municipality with 50,000 citizens pays €50,000 a year for a system.

Investment and running costs are repaid over the contract period (4–10 years).

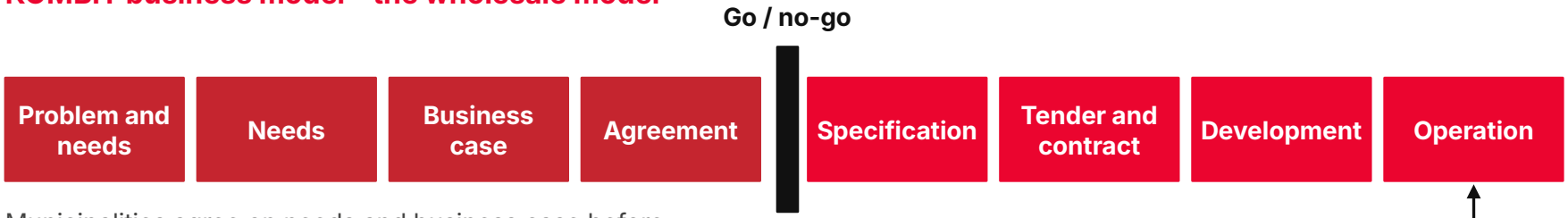
# Project model vs business model

KOMBIT does not run classic IT projects...
It runs a business model where the municipalities commit before anything is bought.

**Classic project model (PRINCE2)**




**KOMBIT business model – the wholesale model**




Municipalities agree on needs and business case before KOMBIT specifies and tenders

**Payment starts when the system is in operation**

03

# Portfolio and infrastructure

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# The portfolio today

**27**

tenders since 2010

**25**

IT solutions in operation

**900,000**

daily users of Aula, the school–parent platform

**150 mio.**

transactions a month on the shared infrastructure

KOMBIT has moved from a project house to a solution house: most solutions now run on the shared infrastructure, and a few new projects are under way.

Examples: Aula · Unemployment benefit system (KY) · Sick leave benefit system (KSD) · Vulnerable children and young people (DUBU) · Case and party overview (SAPA) · Management information (FLIS) · Shared library system (FBS) · Building register (BBR) · Driving test booking · Elections



# The portfolio across municipal service areas

### Social and health

Health insurance
Health insurance portal
Health insurance refunds
Social exemption card
Vulnerable children (DUBU)

### Labour market

Sick leave benefits
Unemployment benefits
Pension system

### Children & learning

Aula – school–parent platform
Library system

### Environment

Building and environmental permits
Building register (BBR)

### Administration

Driving test booking
Benefit reimbursement
Elections

### Across all areas

Citizen portal
Case and party overview (SAPA)
Management information (FLIS)

## Key figures

**€10.8 bn**
refunds from the state calculated across 30 benefits

**€4.4 bn**
paid out by the unemployment system in 2022 · 10,000 users

**€1.8 bn**
paid out by the sick leave system in 2022 · 2,900 users

**900,000**
daily users of Aula

# The bigger picture

**150 mio.** transactions a month

**Cross-municipal solutions** Benefits · pension · sick leave · health insurance · family benefits · housing benefits · children and youth · SAPA · FLIS

## Cross-municipal infrastructure

**Service platform**
Access to business data and functionality

**Access control**
Who can access which information and functions

**Organisation**
Understanding and using the municipal organisation

**Classification**
A common understanding of data and tasks

**Indexes**
Overview of cases, documents, benefits etc.

**Message broker**
Distribution of business events

**National infrastructure and data** MitID / NemLog-in · NemKonto · Digital Post · borger.dk · virk.dk · eIncome · CPR · CVR · BBR · DAR addresses · maps

04

# Cyber and AI

KOMBIT

# The cyber threat against Denmark

**Very high**

**Cyber espionage**
Foreign states continually attempt espionage against organisations in Denmark – and will continue to do so

**Very high**

**Cyber crime**
Among the most prevalent threats. Opportunistic – it can hit citizens, authorities and companies alike

**High**

**Cyber activism**
Driven by Russia's invasion of Ukraine and the war in Gaza; mainly pro-Russian activists

**Medium**

**Destructive attacks**
Primarily from Russian state-sponsored hackers and non-state actors with ties to the Russian state

## KommuneCERT

The municipalities shared cyber defence

**24/365** monitoring

**SAC/SOC** security operations

**500,000+** devices covered

Cooperation with the Norwegian and Swedish municipal CERTs

# AI – what we have learned

- Internal policy first
- Extraordinary investment
- In-house or outsource
- Great results
- Re-use – pool and scale
- Boring is good
- Cross-governmental

## Shared AI infrastructure

Built into the cross-municipal infrastructure, so every solution and municipality can re-use it.

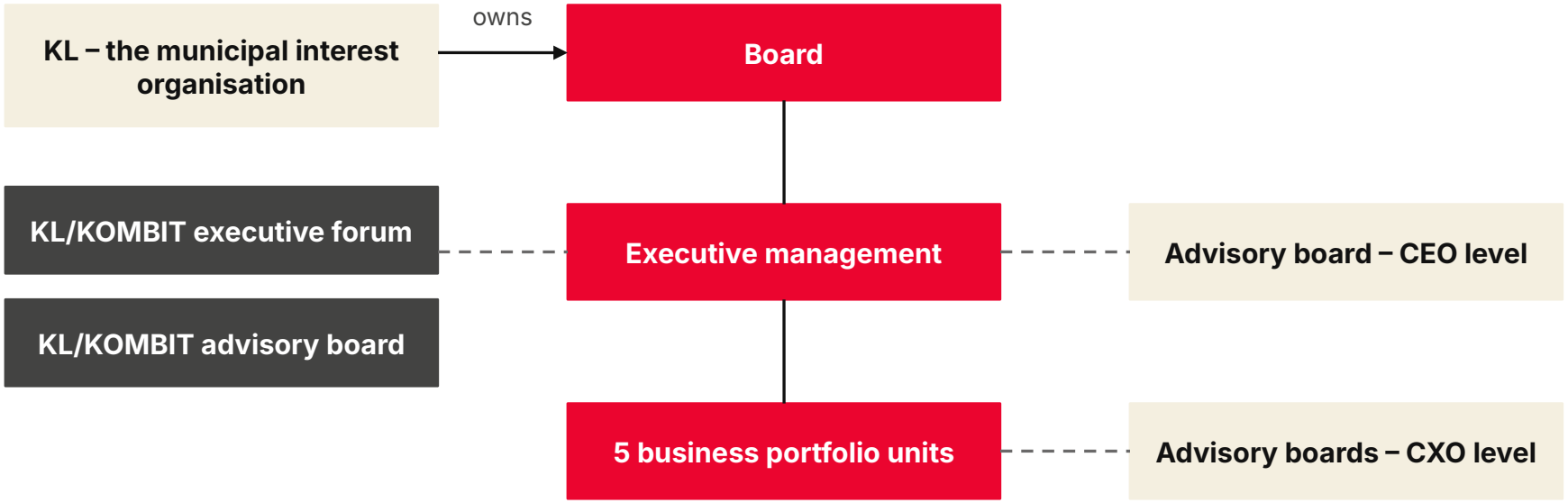
- **Speech to text**
- **Text to speech**
- **Translation**

05

# Governance

KOMBIT

# KOMBIT – corporate structure




The board: 5 mayors and 3 employee representatives. Municipal directors advise at CEO level and per portfolio at CXO level.

# Municipal involvement in ongoing development

The municipalities decide what is developed in the shared business systems – through a fixed prioritisation chain.

**1**

### System users

Municipal users raise change requests and new requirements – hundreds to thousands

→

**2**

### Reference group

Municipal specialists prioritise the requests

→

**3**

### Steering group

Municipal management representatives prioritise across needs

→

**4**

### Development

Selected changes are ordered from the vendor and delivered to all 98

**The cycle repeats continuously – the systems keep evolving with municipal practice.**

06

# The future

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# The challenges ahead

- Aging population
- Recruitment crisis
- Rising welfare expectations
- Climate change
- Security
- Working with technology
- Government structure and democracy



# Strategy 2023+

## KOMBIT delivers

- Solutions, data and infrastructure
- Implementation and use
- Knowledge and consulting

## Core priorities

- Welfare
- Security
- Climate and sustainability

## Means

- Differentiate
- New governance
- Insights, partnership and digitisation-ready legislation




# Togetherness

Thank you